

5. Proxy Pattern.

Provide a surrogate or placeholder for another object to control access to it.

In simple terms:

- Proxy acts as a middle layer.
- Client interacts with proxy instead of the real object.
- Proxy decides how and when to access the real object.

* Why Proxy Exists

Sometimes accessing an object is:-

- Expensive
- Sensitive
- Remote
- Slow.

Example

- Large image loading
- Network service.
- DD Connection
- Access - controlled service.

Proxy helps by:-

- Delaying creation
- Controlling access
- Adds extra logic.

Instead of Client $\rightarrow$ Real Object.

We do Client $\rightarrow$ Proxy $\rightarrow$ Real Object.

The proxy:

- Implements the same interface
- Controls access of the real object.

Ex: Security Guard.

You don't enter a restricted building directly.

You first interact with:

Security Guard $\rightarrow$ verify access $\rightarrow$ allow entry.

Security Guard = Proxy.

Code

1. Subject Interface.

```
interface Image {  
    void display();  
}
```

2. Real Object.

```
class RealImage implements Image {  
    private String filename;  
    RealImage(String filename) {  
        this.filename = filename;  
        loadFromDisk();  
    }  
    private void loadFromDisk() {  
        s.o.pln("Loading " + filename);  
    }  
    public void display() {  
        s.o.pln("Displaying " + filename);  
    }  
}
```

3. Proxy class

```
class ImageProxy implements Image {  
    private RealImage realImage;  
    private String filename;  
    ImageProxy(String filename) {  
        this.filename = filename;  
    }  
    public void display() {  
        if (realImage == null) {  
            realImage = new RealImage(filename);  
        }  
        realImage.display();  
    }  
}
```

4. Client Code.

```
Image image = new ImageProxy("photo.png");
```

```
image.display();  
image.display();
```

- lazy loading
- controlled access
- performance optimization.

Types of Proxy

1. Virtual Proxy used for lazy loading.
 - loading large images.
 - Lazy initialization.
2. Protection Proxy controlled access permissions.
 - user roles.
 - security checks.
3. Remote Proxy. represents an obj in another system.
 - RPC.
 - REST clients.
4. Caching Proxy. shows results to improve performance.
 - API response caching.